

SHOOTING TURNS MASS INTO CHAOS

Motive sought as attack on Catholic school event in Minnesota kills 2 children, sends 17 people to hospital **Nation & World**

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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Trump, Pritzker in fish fight

Already appropriated invasive carp barrier funding up in the air

By **Adriana Pérez**
Chicago Tribune

As tensions rise between Illinois politicians and President Donald Trump over his plans to deploy the National Guard to Chicago, the latter contrasted Democratic governors' resistance to their desire for federal assistance on an issue that has plagued the Great Lakes for decades: invasive carp.

"There's a way of getting rid of those, very expensive," Trump told reporters at the Oval Office on Monday, "and I didn't get a request from the governor of Illinois, (which) is affected maybe more than anybody else, right? And I think until I get that request from that guy, I'm not going to do anything about it."

The president was likely referring to a \$1.15 billion infrastructure project at the Brandon Road Lock and Dam on the Des Plaines River in Joliet, to build the last, multi-pronged line of defense against silver and bighead carp moving upstream.

It's the culmination of decadeslong efforts between Illinois, Michigan and the federal government to stop the invasive fish, which pose a significant threat to the native species and aquatic ecosystems of the Great Lakes, as well as its billion-dollar fishing and boating industries. The fish are currently held back by unreliable electrical barriers near Romeoville.

The federal government will cover 90% of the project's construction costs, with

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'OUR PRESIDENT IS LISTENING'

By **Alice Yin and Jake Sheridan**
Chicago Tribune

The women in red hats are met with eye rolls, indifference and jeers during Chicago City Council meetings.

But in the past week, their movement has been embraced on live TV inside the Oval Office.

"I see Black women wearing a red MAGA hat last night on television: 'Please let the president come in,'" President Donald Trump told reporters on Tuesday from the White House. "You have a force of Black women, Black women ... they want Trump to come in. And you see them, they're all over the place in Chicago."

The broadcast followed Trump's explosive remarks Friday floating the nation's third-largest city as "probably" the next destination to send military troops in his purported crusade against violence. That day, he first cited "African American ladies, beautiful ladies" begging him for

Small but vocal Black MAGA activist groups in Chicago catch Trump's eye

Jessica Jackson, left, and Danielle Carter try to shout their opposition to speakers supporting Chicago's sanctuary city status during a City Council meeting on Jan. 15 at City Hall. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

federal intervention in Chicago as he answered questions about the ongoing, controversial deployment of 2,000 National Guard members in Washington, D.C.

The president's comments triggered a seismic rebuke from Democrats who scoffed at the notion he spoke for Black women in America, much less Chicago.

Some local observers of City Hall's quirks and characters knew exactly who he was talking about.

For over two years, a small but vocal group of Black Trump supporters has occupied a corner of the public seating in Council Chambers, testifying at virtually every meeting to excoriate Mayor Brandon Johnson and other Democrats.

Sporting red shirts and hats with variations of the "Make America Great Again" slogan, the dozen or so Trump supporters have delivered

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CHICAGO PUBLIC SCHOOLS

Laid off custodians left with a mess

More than 1,200 lose jobs amid budget woes

By **Kate Perez, Nell Salzman and Alice Yin**
Chicago Tribune

Rebecca Salazar's morning routine is familiar. For the last three years, she wakes up and travels the few blocks from her house to McNair School of Excellence in Austin, where students and staff know her affectionately as "Miss Becky." The commute is the shortest in her 25 years as a Chicago Public Schools custodian.

Salazar, 65, knows her day will include cleaning floors and bathrooms in between classes long before she steps foot in the school at 11 a.m. The school's second floor, which houses third, fourth, fifth graders and special education students, is hers to maintain. She'll likely be tasked with cleaning up accidents, saving the day by doing the work others often don't want to do. But for the children she has watched grow up and formed connections with, it's



Rebecca Salazar, a Chicago Public Schools custodian, gets ready for work on Wednesday at her home in the city's Austin neighborhood. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

work worth doing.

This month, however, Salazar was blindsided by a layoff notice from the district with no prior warning. Her husband, also a custodian, got the same notice. They were among more than 1,200 privatized custodians laid off by CPS on Aug. 1, part of an effort to save \$40 million as the district tries to plug a \$734 million deficit.

"It's like a slap in the face," Salazar said. "(CPS) ... didn't think about the kids, they didn't think about us, they didn't think about anything."

On Thursday, the board faces mounting pressure to pass a balanced budget, but despite already cutting thousands of jobs, it's still unclear how they'll get there. And in the days leading up to the vote, the fight over labor —

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INSIDE Board faces budget vote

The Chicago Board of Education is set to appoint a new board member the same day as a scheduled vote on a budget for Chicago Public Schools' upcoming fiscal year, capping months of debate over how to close a looming deficit while navigating lingering political tensions. **Chicagoland**, Page 5

■ CPS' Sustainable Community School growing program works to incorporate neighborhood voices into educational structure. **Chicagoland**, Page 3

FDA limits access to COVID-19 vaccines

By **Matthew Perrone**
Associated Press

WASHINGTON — U.S. regulators approved updated COVID-19 shots Wednesday but limited their use for many Americans — and removed one of the two vaccines available for young children.

The new shots from Pfizer, Moderna and Novavax are approved for all seniors. But the Food and Drug Administration narrowed their use for younger adults and children to those with at least one high-risk health condition, such as asthma or obesity. That presents new barriers to access for millions of Americans who would have to prove their risk — and millions more who may want to get vaccinated and suddenly no longer qualify.

Additionally, Pfizer's vaccine will no longer be available for any child under 5, because the FDA

said it was revoking the shot's emergency authorization for that age group.

Parents will still be able to seek out shots from rival drug-maker Moderna, the other maker of mRNA vaccines, which has full FDA approval for children as young as 6 months. But the company's Spikevax vaccine is approved only for children with at least one serious health problem.

The revamped vaccines target a newer version of the continuously evolving virus and are set to begin shipping immediately.

But it could be days or weeks before many Americans know if they'll be able to get one, with access dependent on decisions by federal health advisers, private health insurers, pharmacies and state authorities.

The new restrictions — previewed by FDA officials in

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MORE TURMOIL: Centers for Disease Control and Prevention director ousted just 27 days after being sworn in, officials say. **Nation & World**

TODAY'S WEATHER



High **75** Low **56**

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 12

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
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